TASK-LEVEL SELECTION · WITHIN EVERY EXPERIENCE MODE

# Follow the task. Choose the interaction.

Assess task certainty, reasoning need, result structure and action consequences to choose the interaction model.

START

## 01 Task certainty

How clearly is the task already defined?

DECISION
**Does the user already know exactly what they want to accomplish?**

YES

DECISION
**Are the inputs, actions, and expected outputs known and predictable?**

YES

DECISION
**Does the task require meaningful reasoning or interpretation?**

NO

INTERACTION MODEL
**Traditional UI**
EXAMPLES
- Create / renew certificate
- Configure MCP server
- Add / manage users
- Configure LLM endpoint

YES

STAGE REFERENCE
**Continue to Stage 2**
EXAMPLES
- Which configuration change caused this degradation?

Go to stage 2 ↓

NO

STAGE REFERENCE
**Continue to Stage 2**

Go to stage 2 ↓

NO

DECISION
**Does the user know the desired outcome but not the path to achieve it?**

YES

STAGE REFERENCE
**Continue to Stage 2**
EXAMPLES
- Why is this service degraded?

Go to stage 2 ↓

NO

DECISION
**Is this primarily a known lookup, navigation, or structured task?**

YES

INTERACTION MODEL
**Traditional UI**
EXAMPLES
- Browse certificates
- View users
- Check cluster status

NO

REFRAME
**Reframe the task before choosing the interaction**

CONTINUE ASSESSMENT · STAGE 2

## 02 Reasoning need

How much interpretation should AI perform?

DECISION
**Does the task require exploration, reasoning, synthesis, or explanation?**

NO

INTERACTION MODEL
**Traditional UI**
EXAMPLES
- Assign a role
- Update a known configuration
- Select devices and perform a predefined operation

YES

DECISION
**Does the user know the goal but need the system to determine how to get there?**

YES

INTERACTION MODEL
**Conversational / Agentic**
Strong indication
EXAMPLES
- Find the root cause of this incident.
- Why is VPN-102 degraded?
- What changed before the outage?

NO

DECISION
**Is interpretation still the primary user need?**

YES

INTERACTION MODEL
**Conversational / Agentic**
Interpretation is the primary need
EXAMPLES
- Explain this alarm.
- Why were these events correlated?
- Why is BGP the likely root cause?

NO

STAGE REFERENCE
**Continue to Stage 3**

Go to stage 3 ↓

CONTINUE ASSESSMENT

DECISION
**Does the reasoning span multiple products, domains, or data sources?**

YES

INTERACTION MODEL
**Conversational / Agentic**
Stronger indication

Event Correlation · Configuration Drift · Topology · Telemetry · Routing · Historical state

EXAMPLES
- Why did this service fail after the maintenance window?

CONTINUE ASSESSMENT

STAGE REFERENCE
**Continue to Stage 3**

Go to stage 3 ↓

NO

STAGE REFERENCE
**Continue based on the type of result required**

Go to stage 3 ↓

CONTINUE ASSESSMENT · STAGE 3

## 03 Result structure

What does the user need to do with the result?

DECISION
**Is the user mainly trying to understand—or inspect and manipulate?**

A · UNDERSTAND / ASK / REASON

INTERACTION MODEL
**Conversational / Agentic**
Understanding and reasoning
EXAMPLES
- Why is this alarm appearing?
- Why were these events grouped?
- What changed before the outage?

B · INSPECT / COMPARE / MANIPULATE / VALIDATE

DECISION
**Does the result contain meaningful structured operational state?**

Devices · Services · Incidents · Hypotheses · Evidence · Topology · Timelines · Configuration differences · Recommendations · Validation results

NO

INTERACTION MODEL
**Conversational / Agentic may remain sufficient**

YES

INTERACTION MODEL
**Hybrid**

Affected services · Hypotheses · Evidence · Validation · Root cause

EXAMPLES
- Investigate packet loss at HYD-23.

CONTINUE ASSESSMENT

DECISION
**Does the user need to compare, filter, select, edit, drill down, validate, or approve?**

YES

INTERACTION MODEL
**Hybrid**
EXAMPLES
- Compare config differences
- Review hypotheses
- Filter correlated events
- Validate remediation

NO

INTERACTION MODEL
**Lightweight Hybrid**

CONTINUE ASSESSMENT · STAGE 4

## 04 Action & consequence

How much structure and control are required?

DECISION
**Does the workflow lead to a network or platform action?**

NO

STAGE REFERENCE
**Keep the interaction model selected in the previous stages**

YES

DECISION
**What happens if the result or decision is wrong?**

LOW CONSEQUENCE

INTERACTION MODEL
**Conversational or lightweight Hybrid**
EXAMPLES
- Explanation
- Informational recommendation

MEDIUM CONSEQUENCE

INTERACTION MODEL
**Hybrid**
Evidence + verification
EXAMPLES
- Root-cause diagnosis
- Remediation recommendation

HIGH CONSEQUENCE

INTERACTION MODEL
**Hybrid + structured controls**
Required visibility

Scope · Impact · Evidence · Proposed change · Validation · Approval · Rollback · Audit

EXAMPLES
- Production configuration change
- Traffic rerouting
- Policy deployment
- Service-impacting remediation

FINAL INTERACTION MODEL

### FINAL INTERACTION MODEL

INTERACTION MODEL
**Traditional UI**

Known task · Predictable inputs · Repeatable workflow · Limited reasoning · Precision / manipulation important

EXAMPLES
- Certificate creation
- MCP setup
- User management
- Cluster configuration
- LLM configuration

INTERACTION MODEL
**Conversational / Agentic**

Goal known · Path unclear · Reasoning / exploration central · Interpretation more important than manipulation

EXAMPLES
- Explain an incident
- Find likely root cause
- Understand network behaviour
- Ask a cross-domain operational question

INTERACTION MODEL
**Hybrid**

Reasoning required · Structured operational state · Evidence needs inspection · Results need manipulation / validation · User may need to take action

EXAMPLES
- DNT investigation
- Event Correlation
- Configuration Drift analysis
- Remediation
- Agent Evaluation

Source: Crosswork AI — Interaction Model Design Framework, §3.